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Brightlearn_Exercise1_ SQL Fundamentals Ivy-Clarke 21 June 2026

Brightlearn - Exercise 1 - SQL - Fundamentals

Question

Retrieve all columns from employees table

Syntax

```
SELECT id,  
       first-name,  
       last-name,  
       department,  
       salary,  
       hire-date,  
       city
```

FROM employees;

or syntax

```
SELECT *  
FROM employees;
```

TABLE employees

id	first-name	last-name	department	Salary	hire-date	City
1	Alice	Green	IT	70000	2020-01-10	Johannesburg
2	Brian	Lee	HR	45000	2019-03-22	Cape town
3	Corthy	Zulu	Finance	65000	2018-07-18	Durban
4	David	Mokone	Marketing	50000	2021-11-05	Pretoria
5	Eva	Meindoo	IT	72000	2017-09-30	Johannesburg

Question 2

Find all unique departments

```
SELECT DISTINCT department  
FROM employees;
```

RESULTS

Table employees

Department
IT
HR
Finance
Marketing
IT

Question 3

```
SELECT first_name,  
last_name
```

```
FROM employees
```

```
ORDER BY salary DESC;
```

first_name	last_name
Andrea Eva	Maidoo
Andrea Alice	Green
Cathy	Zulu
David	Mokoena
Brian	Lee

Question 4

Retrieve the top 3 highest paid employees

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       salary
```

```
FROM employees
```

```
WHERE department IN ('IT', 'HR', 'Finance', 'Marketing')
```

```
ORDER BY salary DESC
```

```
LIMIT 3;
```

id	first_name	last_name	salary
5	Eva	Naldoo	72000
1	Alice	Green	70000
3	Cathy	Zulu	65000

Question 5

Find employees in IT department

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department department
```

```
FROM employees
```

```
WHERE department = 'IT';
```

id	first_name	last_name	department
1	Alice	Green	IT
5	Eva	Naldoo	IT

Question 6
Find employees in Finance with salary > 6000

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department,  
       salary  
FROM employees  
WHERE department = 'Finance'  
AND salary > 6000;
```

id	first_name	last_name	department	salary
3	Cathy	Zulu	Finance	65000

Question 7
Find employees in HR or Marketing

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department
```

```
FROM employees  
WHERE department = 'HR' OR 'Marketing';
```

Results

id	first_name	last_name	department
2	Brian	Lee	HR
4	David	Mokoena	Marketing

Question 8

Find employees not in IT

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department  
FROM employees  
WHERE NOT department = 'IT';
```

Results

id	first_name	last_name	department
2	Brian	Lee	HR
3	Cathy	Zulu	Finance
4	David	Moores	Marketing

Question 9

Find employees in IT, HR or Finance using IN

```
SELECT id,  
       first_name,  
       last_name,  
       department  
FROM employees  
WHERE department IN ('IT', 'HR', 'Finance');
```

Results

id	first_name	last_name	department
1	Alice	Green	IT
2	Brian	Lee	HR
3	Cathy	Zulu	Finance
5	Eva	Haiboo	IT

Question 10

Find employees in IT with salary > 65000 and City Johannesburg

```
SELECT id  
       first-name,  
       last-name,  
       department,  
       salary,  
       city
```

from

employees

WHERE

department = 'IT'

AND

salary > 65000

~~AND~~ AND city = 'Johannesburg';

Results

id	first-name	last-name	department	salary	city
1	Alice	Green	IT	70000	Johannesburg
5	Eva	Heidloo	IT	72000	Johannesburg